Yes — what you're looking for is **programmatic PDF generation (not screenshot / not HTML rendering)**. There are several libraries that generate **true text-based PDFs** (vector text, selectable, searchable).

Here are the best ones depending on your stack:

Node.js / JavaScript

1. **PDFKit**

- Pure programmatic PDF generation (no HTML, no screenshots)
- You manually write text, layout, fonts

```
const PDFDocument = require('pdfkit');
const doc = new PDFDocument();

doc.text('Hello world');
doc.end();
```

Pros:

- Lightweight
- Full control over layout
- True text (selectable/searchable)

Cons:

- You must handle layout manually

It's explicitly **not HTML-based**, you construct PDFs directly (Medium)

---

2. **PDF-lib**

- Pure JS (no native deps)
- Works in Node + browser

Pros:

- Modify + create PDFs
- No external engine

Cons:

- Low-level API

Works directly with PDF structure (not rendering HTML) (PDFBolt)

---

3. **jsPDF**

- Mostly frontend
- Can write text directly

Good for:

- Simple client-side PDFs

Not ideal for:

- Complex layouts / backend

Java

4. **Apache PDFBox**

- Mature, pure Java library
- Full control over text, fonts, layout

Can create, edit, and extract PDFs programmatically (Wikipedia)

---

5. **iText**

- Very powerful (enterprise-level)
- Supports forms, encryption, signatures

Widely used for generating PDFs programmatically (Wikipedia)

---

6. **OpenPDF**

- Open-source alternative to iText
- Similar API

Fork created due to licensing changes (Wikipedia)

PHP

7. **TCPDF**

- Pure PHP PDF generation
- Strong Unicode support

Widely used in CMS systems (Wikipedia)

C / C+ +

8. **libHaru**

- Lightweight C/C+ +library
- Generates PDFs with text, fonts, images

Designed specifically for creating PDFs (not editing) (Wikipedia)

Key distinction (important)

Approach	Example	Output
Screenshot-based	Puppeteer	Image-like PDF
HTML rendering	wkhtmltopdf	HTML → PDF
Programmatic	PDFKit, PDFBox	**Pure text PDF**

Recommendation (based on your background)

Since you're a **Next.js / Angular dev**:

Best choice:

- **PDFKit** → if you want backend generation
- **PDF-lib** → if you want browser + backend flexibility

Simple rule

If you want:

- **Selectable text → use these libraries **
- **Pixel-perfect UI copy → use Puppeteer **

If you tell me your exact use case (invoice, report, table-heavy, multilingual, etc.), I can suggest the *best library + structure* for your project.